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ARTICLE

From Hamas Youth Camps To America's Backyard: Who Is Radicalizing Our Teens?



BY PNW STAFF OCTOBER 13, 2026

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When Americans hear about terrorist organizations indoctrinating children at summer camps, they usually picture Gaza, Lebanon, or some distant battlefield

They imagine young people being taught to glorify martyrdom, celebrate armed struggle, and view violence as a legitimate path to revolutionary warfare.

But what happens when American teenagers begin attending camps where Hezbollah flags are displayed, communist insurgencies are studied, and revolutionary warfare is celebrated?

According to a disturbing new investigation by the New York Post, that is precisely the kind of environment young people encountered at a secretive summer camp held in the Pacific Northwest this past August.

The gathering, organized by the Anti-Imperialist Front USA (AIF-USA), reportedly brought together high school students, community college students, and young workers for ideological instruction, physical activities, and revolutionary solidarity.

Photographs showed participants gathered around a campfire alongside flags associated with Hezbollah, Iran, and other movements aligned with the so-called Axis of Resistance. One banner proclaimed, "Victory to the Axis of Resistance!"

This was not a gathering in Tehran or Beirut. It was happening in the United States.

And the deeper question is not simply what these young people were learning over summer vacation. It is who is teaching them, how they are being recruited, and what kind of worldview they are being encouraged to embrace.



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A Familiar Strategy With A Disturbing American Twist

For years, terrorist organizations such as Hamas and Hezbollah have understood something about shaping future generations: ideological loyalty can be cultivated long before someone is old enough to carry a weapon.

Hamas has operated youth camps in Gaza where children have been exposed to militant propaganda and, in some programs, military-style activities. Hezbollah's youth organizations have likewise been accused of using educational and recreational programs to promote the group's ideology and cultivate future recruits.

The objective is not always immediate combat training. It is creating an identity, establishing loyalty, and teaching young people who their enemies are.

That makes the revelations from the Pacific Northwest particularly troubling.

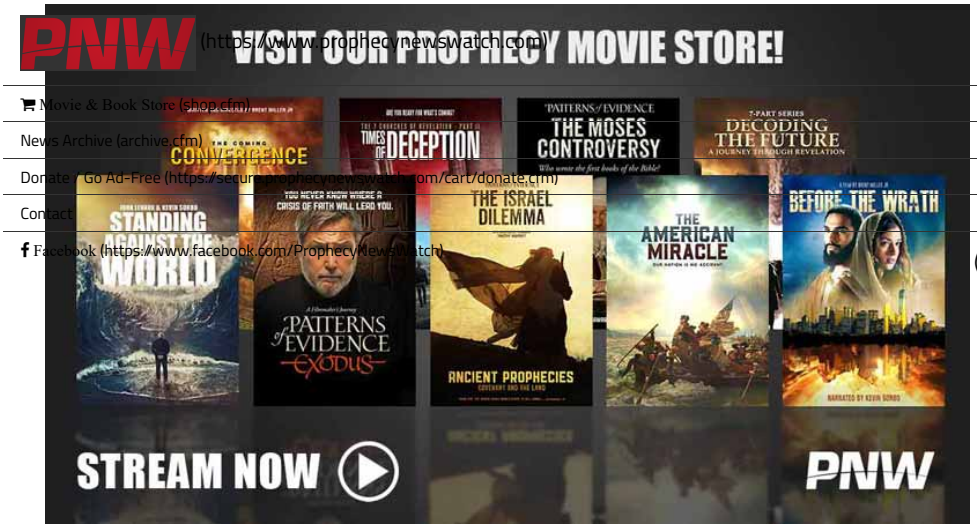
The reported curriculum and symbolism reveal an ideological admiration for movements that embrace revolutionary violence.

According to the camp organizers' own published description, participants studied revolutionary movements in Peru, Turkey, India, and the Philippines, presenting their armed struggles as examples of liberation.

The organizers also emphasized solidarity with the Axis of Resistance, including Iran, Hezbollah, and Yemen's Houthis.

These are not simply abstract political theories. Several of the organizations being praised or studied have histories involving bombings, assassinations, kidnappings, and attacks on civilians.

What kind of message does it send to American teenagers when movements responsible for such violence are presented as models of revolutionary achievement?



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From School Walkouts To Revolutionary Summer Camps

Perhaps the most alarming aspect of the investigation is how young people reportedly become involved.

The North American Values Institute, an education watchdog organization, alleges that Revolutionary Youth, an organization associated with AIF-USA, recruits students through political activism at high schools across the West Coast.

According to the watchdog, the organization has helped coordinate school walkouts, including demonstrations marking the anniversary of the October 7 Hamas attacks on Israel.

Students may initially encounter these groups through causes they believe are humanitarian: opposition to war, concern for Palestinian civilians, or demands for social justice.

Those concerns do not make someone an extremist. Peaceful protest and criticism of government policies are legitimate forms of political expression.

But there is an enormous difference between advocating for civilians caught in a war and being introduced to organizations that glorify terrorist movements or promote armed revolution as a solution to political disagreements.

That distinction becomes especially important when minors are involved.

A teenager attending a school demonstration may have little understanding of the larger ideological network behind its organizers. Parents may know even less.

The danger is that political activism can become an entry point into increasingly radical environments where violence is romanticized, revolutionary martyrs are celebrated, and loyalty to the movement becomes central to a young person's identity.

The camp reportedly included participants associated with Revolutionary Youth chapters in Seattle, Bellevue, Bellingham, Issaquah, and the broader Puget Sound region.

The precise location of the gathering remains unclear.

Learning From Movements With Blood On Their Hands

The curriculum itself deserves serious scrutiny.

Among the movements reportedly studied was Peru's Shining Path, a Maoist insurgency responsible for widespread atrocities during a decades-long campaign to overthrow the Peruvian government.

The group became notorious for massacres, assassinations, bombings, and the deliberate targeting of civilians. Its revolutionary ambitions helped plunge Peru into a conflict that killed tens of thousands of people.

Participants also studied Turkey's Marxist-Leninist insurgency and India's Maoist movement, organizations associated with armed attacks and prolonged revolutionary conflict.

What makes the camp particularly revealing is how its organizers described these struggles.

Rather than presenting them primarily as historical warnings about the human cost of revolutionary violence, the organizers portrayed people's wars as a path toward liberation.

AIF-USA has also published material titled "Learn From Hezbollah!" promoting lessons from the Iran-backed organization.

violence directed against civilians.

Yet its ideology and resistance strategy were being presented by these activists as worthy of admiration.

This raises an uncomfortable question: How did movements associated with political terror become inspirational material for an American youth gathering?

The International Connections Raise More Questions

The controversy extends beyond the camp itself.

AIF-USA's website was reportedly hosted through infrastructure operated by Autistici/Inventati, an Italian technology collective sanctioned by the U.S. Treasury Department on August 26, 2026.

American authorities accused the collective of providing technological services to violent extremist organizations, including web hosting and encrypted communications.

The Treasury Department also sanctioned Masar Badil, which it identified as a front for the Popular Front for the Liberation of Palestine, a U.S.-designated terrorist organization.

The combination of revolutionary instruction, explicit praise for militant organizations, and connections to a broader international activist environment raises legitimate questions about the ideological networks influencing American youth.

These questions deserve careful investigation rather than dismissal as ordinary campus politics.

Where Are The Parents, Churches, And Schools?

For Christians, there is another dimension to this story that should not be overlooked.

Scripture repeatedly warns about the power of instruction, the influence of companions, and the responsibility adults bear for shaping the next generation.

Proverbs 22:6 emphasizes training children in the way they should go. Proverbs 13:20 warns that those who associate with fools suffer harm. Romans 12:21 instructs believers not to be overcome by evil, but to overcome evil with good.

The Bible does not teach indifference toward injustice. Christians are called to defend the vulnerable, pursue righteousness, and speak truth even when doing so is unpopular.

But biblical justice is not a license to celebrate the murder of innocents, glorify terrorism, or embrace revolutionary violence as a moral virtue.

Young people are naturally drawn to causes that promise meaning, belonging, and the opportunity to change the world. Those desires can be directed toward service, compassion, courage, and genuine justice.

They can also be exploited by movements that divide humanity into oppressors and enemies, teaching that almost any action becomes acceptable if committed in the name of a supposedly righteous cause.

That is why parents and churches cannot afford to treat ideological education as something happening only inside classrooms.

Political messages now reach teenagers through social media, student organizations, demonstrations, online communities, and apparently even summer camps.

The question is not whether young people should care about injustice. They absolutely should.

The question is whether they are being taught to recognize evil consistently, including when it appears wrapped in the language of liberation.

The Battle For The Next Generation Is Already Underway

~~What remains unknown about this particular camp, including the precise number of minors involved and whether any activities went beyond ideological instruction.~~

~~But the publicly reported material is troubling enough without exaggeration.~~

~~American teenagers reportedly attended a gathering where revolutionary insurgencies were celebrated, terrorist-linked symbolism was displayed, and movements responsible for serious violence were treated as examples worthy of study and solidarity.~~

The broader concern is not confined to one camp or one organization.

It is the possibility that young Americans are being taught to admire the very movements whose brutality has devastated communities overseas.

For decades, Americans have watched reports of militant youth indoctrination in the Middle East and wondered how societies could allow children to be raised in environments that glorify violence.

Now a version of that ideological influence appears to be reaching young people much closer to home.

And if parents, educators, and churches are not paying attention to who is shaping the convictions of the next generation, they may discover that others have been doing the teaching all along.

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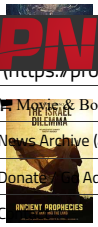
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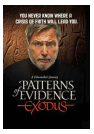
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